

Even at this early date, we might speculate on just a few developments that appear likely. For instance, I would be inclined to expect (in no particular order or time frame) that the Middle East and Latin America will destabilize; producing countries will wage a trade war of increasing tariffs; fashionable women will sport floor length skirts and dresses; horror movies will reach new depths of depravity and at least one will win an award; gang and political violence will wax; an epidemic will erupt; articles and seminars will appear on "How to Declare Bankruptcy and Walk Away From Debt"; the U.S. government will make it a crime to send money out of the country and seize property from citizens trying to flee with assets; militias will declare independence from the U.S. government and clash with federal police; immigration, emigration and foreign travel will be restricted; a nationalistic dictator will take over in Russia; secessionist movements will take place in many countries, including the U.S.; tales of corruption among banking and government officials will surface; new political parties will gain strength and receive press coverage; the U.S. government will abandon the Drug War; one or both of the current political parties will disappear; state and local governments will slash services; North Korea, Cuba, and much of Africa will experience famine; Russia will retire the ruined ruble; a tax revolt will take place; wars will erupt in Asia and the Middle East; the World Bank will fail; a major commodity exchange and a minor stock exchange will fold; the unemployment rate will exceed 30%; several major world powers will become engaged in armed conflict; nihilistic art will become fashionable; there will be a run on the banks and a nationwide closure; Congress will pass laws designed to prevent the stock and bond market debacles that have already occurred; a U.S. president will resign, be impeached, or be rejected for a second term by a landslide vote with record turnout; the Fed will be nationalized; there will be food riots; foreigners will commit terrorist acts on U.S. soil; the U.S. government will adopt numerous police state style controls; radical ideas will be introduced into the political debate; over half the House and nearly one third of the Senate will be thrown out of office in a Congressional election; Social Security, Medicare, workers' compensation, food stamps and minimum wage laws will be repealed, either entirely or to be replaced by a single "national assistance" program; moralists, authoritarians, Patriots and Libertarians will gain political clout; major international agreements will be broken; several nuclear bombs will be detonated in acts of war; finally, World War III will